Religion and Morality — Continuous At-a-Glance Master Flow

Four relations -> divine command -> Euthyphro -> modified command -> autonomy -> natural law -> secular field -> influence -> criticism -> dharma and karma -> non-theistic groundings -> both directions -> all the time -> religiosity -> violence and restraint -> Nietzsche -> synthesis

Read the numbered rail top to bottom. Stages 00-17 are the complete core spine and answer every printed question this clause owns; the final subordinate stage E is optional enrichment only.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW
● SUBORDINATE EXTRA
● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Regenerated in place for the Religion and Morality repair; all prior artifacts unchanged and awaiting user review.

00

STAGE 00 FOUR RELATIONS HIDING INSIDE ONE CLAIM

METAPHYSICAL GROUNDING
EPISTEMIC ACCESS
MOTIVATIONAL FORCE
SANCTION AND ACCOUNTABILITY
SOCIOLOGICAL CORRELATION = THE IMPOSTOR
SEMANTIC / METAPHYSICAL / MOTIVATIONAL
CONSTITUTIVE VERSUS SUPPORTIVE
SYLLABUS: RELIGION AND MORALITY

GROUNDING -> KNOWLEDGE -> MOTIVATION -> SANCTION

and, standing outside all four, SOCIOLOGICAL CORRELATION

THE FOUR QUESTIONS, AND THEIR NON-RELIGIOUS ANSWERS

- Grounding — what constitutes validity: divine nature, command or created order against moral realism, rational autonomy, flourishing and contract.
- Knowledge — how agents find out: revelation, scripture, conscience, tradition and exemplars against reason, experience, empathy and public argument.
- Motivation — what moves a costly act: love, gratitude, hope, repentance, salvation and community against duty, character, solidarity, compassion and self-respect.
- Sanction — what links conduct to consequence: judgement, sin, forgiveness, karma and eschatology against law, social response, conscience and ordinary consequence.

THE IMPOSTOR THAT COSTS THE MOST MARKS

- Sociological correlation establishes at most a contingent influence, and may require controls for community, selection and orientation before even that is secure.
- It cannot show what makes an act right, who can know it, or whether divine command theory survives the Euthyphro.

THREE STRENGTHS INSIDE THE GROUNDING COLUMN

- Semantic: 'wrong' MEANS forbidden by God — strongest and least defensible.
- Metaphysical: wrongness is CONSTITUTED by prohibition — this is the real thesis and the Euthyphro's actual target.
- Motivational: belief in God is what makes agents comply — true of many agents, and decisive about nothing.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Success in one relation proves no dependence in another, so a victory in the motivational column cannot be spent in the grounding column.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The question is not whether religion and morality are connected but which of four separable relations a stem asserts, and an answer that does not say so has not begun.

01

STAGE 01 WHY THE CLAUSE EXISTS, AND THE ONLY DATABLE ANCHORS

EUTHYPHRO c.399-390 BCE
RING OF GYGES c.380-375 BCE
LOCKE 1689
HUME 1751
NIETZSCHE 1887
PRICHARD AND SCHELER 1912
ADAMS 1999
CITE BY WORK, NEVER BY INVENTED YEAR

divine will -> Plato's question -> escape upward -> escape sideways ->

escape outward -> the question turns back on religion

THE SIX-STAGE ORIGIN RAIL

- Morality is presented as the content of a divine will; Plato then asks whether the will TRACKS goodness or CREATES it — so the dilemma is older than every escape built for it.
- Escape upward to the divine NATURE (natural law, later modified divine command); escape sideways to rational SELF-legislation (Kant); escape outward to whole systems with no commander at all (Mimamsa, Buddhist intention, Jain vows, secular theory).
- The question then turns back on religion: does religiosity improve conduct, and can a religious premise ever license violence? The clause exists because the escapes succeed only partially and the last question is settled by none of them.

DATED PRINT ANCHORS — ASSERT THESE, INVENT NO OTHERS

- Plato, Euthyphro 10a; Republic II 359d-360b. Hobbes, Leviathan 1651. Locke, A Letter Concerning Toleration 1689. Hume, Enquiry IX.ii 1751.
- Bradley, Ethical Studies Essay II 1876. Nietzsche, Genealogy of Morality 1887. Prichard, Mind 1912. Scheler, Ressentiment 1912. Walzer 1977. Adams 1999.

ANACHRONISM CONTROL

- The Euthyphro is not an objection to Christian divine-command theory; it is the original statement of a structural problem later theories inherit.
- Mimamsa is not a secular ethics: it is scripturally grounded with no commander who is a person. Nietzsche attacks a Christian-Platonic inheritance the Indian systems never possessed, so the death of God must not be transplanted into Indian material.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A calendar timeline is not the natural shape of a dispute about a relation between two concepts, so the rail supplies the logic and the strip supplies the only assertable dates.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The dilemma that organises this clause is older than every theory constructed to escape it, which is why the escapes are best read as answers to one question rather than as rival schools.

02

STAGE 02 DIVINE COMMAND THEORY AT FULL STRENGTH

OBLIGATION CONSISTS IN BEING COMMANDED
AUTHORITY OVER PREFERENCE
SUPREME PERSONAL LEGISLATOR
DIVINE KNOWLEDGE AND GOODNESS
ACCOUNTABILITY
ACCESS COST
HETERONOMY COST
ABRAHAMIC COMMAND CASES

THE ARGUMENT IN FOUR STEPS

- Obligation has authority over mere preference; a supreme personal legislator can issue universally binding commands.
- Divine knowledge and goodness secure the right content; accountability supplies motivational seriousness. Therefore obligation is constituted by divine command.

THE THREE PRESUPPOSITIONS — NAME THEM

- God exists. Divine commands are knowable by fallible agents. Authority as such can generate moral reasons.
- Kant denies the third while granting the first two, which is where the philosophical action is and what most scripts never state.

WHAT THE THEORY BUYS, AND WHAT IT ALREADY OWES

- Buys objectivity, universality, authority over preference and motivational seriousness — concede these before objecting.
- Owes an access cost, since no reliable access to the command means no access to the obligation, and a heteronomy cost, since obligation from another will enforced by accountability is obedience rather than autonomy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Command is constitutive of obligation, not evidential, motivational or reinforcing, and an objection aimed anywhere else has missed the theory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Divine command theory is not the pious thought that God approves of good conduct but the far stronger claim that the command is what obligation is.

03

STAGE 03 THE EUTHYPHRO FORK AND THE PRICE OF EACH HORN

EUTHYPHRO 10a
HORN 1: ARBITRARINESS
HORN 2: INDEPENDENCE
VACUITY OF DIVINE GOODNESS
KILLS A THEORY, NOT A RELIGION
A THEIST MAY OCCUPY HORN 2
MORALITY HAS AUTONOMY IN GROUNDING

HORN 1 — COMMAND CONSTITUTES GOODNESS

- Cruelty would have been good had it been commanded, because on this horn there is no standard prior to the command against which a command could be assessed.
- The sharper consequence: 'God is good' collapses into 'God commands what God commands', so the horn empties the doctrine of divine goodness as well as morality.

HORN 2 — THE COMMAND FOLLOWS GOODNESS

- God recognises a standard he did not invent, so goodness is not constituted by command and the strong theory is false as an account of grounding.
- This is a comfortable position for a theist who is not a divine command theorist, and the natural-law tradition sits there deliberately.

WHAT SURVIVES THE DILEMMA

- Morality cannot be wholly reducible to divine command, so it has autonomy at the level of grounding.
- Untouched: that religion motivates and sustains moral life, and that morality purifies religion — which is why the balanced conclusion is the interaction view.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The dilemma offers the theist a choice between a morality he would not want and a God he did not intend, and one horn alone is not a dilemma at all.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Euthyphro is not an argument against God but an argument against a theory of obligation, which is exactly why a theist can occupy its second horn without loss.

04

STAGE 04 MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND, AND THE BILL IT PAYS

ADAMS: FINITE AND INFINITE GOODS 1999
OBLIGATION FROM A LOVING GOD
GOODNESS FROM RESEMBLANCE
ALSTON: SUPREME STANDARD
ZAGZEBSKI: DIVINE MOTIVATION
RESIDUE: CONCEPTUAL INDEPENDENCE
RELOCATION, NOT REFUTATION

THE SPLIT THAT BLOCKS HORN 1

- Adams divides the question: obligation is generated by the commands of an essentially loving God, while goodness is grounded in resemblance to that God's nature.
- A necessarily loving nature cannot issue a command to cruelty, so the counterexample the arbitrariness horn requires is closed off by modal structure rather than by a promise about divine behaviour.

TWO PARALLEL REPAIRS

- Alston: God is the supreme standard of goodness, not a conformer to a further one — as the standard metre bar was the standard of length without matching a prior length, so there is no vicious regress and no arbitrariness.
- Zagzebski's divine motivation theory grounds moral value in God's motives rather than God's commands, converting a command-ethic into a virtue-ethic.

THE RESIDUAL OBJECTION, AND THE DEFENDER'S REPLY

- Calling the divine nature loving deploys a moral concept whose content we must already grasp independently, so non-arbitrariness is bought with conceptual independence.
- Defenders answer that every foundational theory borrows a concept it does not ground; the counter is that the direction of grounding, not the borrowing, is what is embarrassed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The repair works and it is paid for, so the honest verdict is that the dilemma is relocated one level up rather than refuted.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The modified theory wins and loses in the same sentence: it secures non-arbitrariness by grounding commands in a loving nature and thereby concedes that we grasp love morally before the theory begins.

05

STAGE 05 KANTIAN AUTONOMY: OBLIGATION WITHOUT A COMMANDER

ACTION FROM DUTY
DESIRE CANNOT YIELD NECESSITY
UNIVERSAL LAW TEST
AUTONOMY AS SELF-LEGISLATION
HETERONOMY DESTROYS MORAL WORTH
GOD, FREEDOM, IMMORTALITY = POSTULATES
FORMALISM OBJECTION
HUMANITY AS AN END

duty -> necessity -> universalisation -> self-legislation

AUTONOMY | HETERONOMY: the fork on which sanction-based religion falls

THE FOUR-STEP ARGUMENT

- Moral worth requires action from duty rather than merely in accordance with it; contingent desire cannot yield the necessity obligation has.
- Rational agents therefore test maxims for universal law, and autonomy is obedience to a reason one shares as rational — freedom rather than constraint.

THE FORK THAT DECIDES THE CLAUSE

- Autonomy: law given by reason to itself, obligation unconditional, moral worth preserved. Heteronomy: law from another will or from desire, reward and fear, obligation conditional, moral worth lost.
- A truthful act motivated only by fear of divine punishment therefore lacks the moral worth of the same act done from duty — which is a deeper objection to command theory than the Euthyphro.

WHERE GOD ACTUALLY ENTERS, AND WHAT IS OWED

- God, freedom and immortality are practical postulates — what reason must presuppose for the moral outlook to be coherent — and not the source of the moral law.
- The formalism objection is that universalisation underdetermines content; the reply adds humanity as an end and the kingdom of ends. Autonomy is never moral subjectivism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Kant removes God from the foundation rather than from morality, since on his account a God who grounded obligation by commanding it would have destroyed what he was grounding.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Obligation binds because a rational agent legislates it universally, so normative principles need not refer to God in order to obligate at all.

06

STAGE 06 NATURAL LAW AS THE MEDIATING POSITION

PARTICIPATION IN AN OBJECTIVE ORDER
GROUNDED IN DIVINE REASON, NOT WILL
KNOWN BY PRACTICAL REASON
BASIC GOODS: LIFE, COOPERATION
OCCUPIES HORN 2 DELIBERATELY
NATURE-TO-NORM OBJECTION
GOODS GRASPED AS REASONS

THE POSITION BETWEEN ITS TWO NEIGHBOURS

- Strong divine command supplies content by decree and needs revelation for moral knowledge; Kantian autonomy supplies both order and content from reason alone.
- Natural law supplies the ORDER from divine reason and the ACCESS from practical reason: God grounds the order, but reason knows much of it without revelation.

ARGUMENT AND EXAMPLE

- Human goods and inclinations disclose basic ends; practical reason directs conduct toward them; divine grounding explains why the order is objective rather than conventional.
- Preservation of life and social cooperation are treated as basic goods, not as goods merely because a text commands them.

THE OBJECTION AND THE STRATEGIC GAIN

- Nature-to-norm risks the naturalistic fallacy; the reply is that practical reason grasps goods AS REASONS, so the premise is normative from the start.
- Introducing the position makes the debate three-cornered, which lets a script refute strong divine command without concluding that theism says nothing about grounding.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the ground is divine reason rather than divine will, the arbitrariness horn cannot be generated, and there is no moment at which the order could have been otherwise.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Natural law is the theistic ethics the Euthyphro was always going to leave standing, because it accepts the second horn deliberately instead of defending against it.

07

STAGE 07 THE SECULAR FIELD: FOUR GROUNDINGS, FOUR BILLS

UTILITARIAN: WELFARE
CONTRACTARIAN: MUTUAL ADVANTAGE
VIRTUE: FLOURISHING
HUMANIST: DIGNITY
THE PLURALITY IS THE ARGUMENT
MOTIVATION GAP
RELIGIOUS-CAPITAL OBJECTION
NECESSITY REFUTED, NOT THEISM

FOUR FAMILIES AND THEIR STANDING OBJECTIONS

- Utilitarian welfare and impartial maximisation — rights-override and demandingness.
- Contractarian mutual advantage — the undetected defector. Virtue and eudaimonist flourishing — a thick human nature the sceptic can decline. Humanist dignity and solidarity — the source of that worth.

WHY PLURALITY IS THE ARGUMENT

- A necessity claim falls to working alternatives, and falls harder to several alternatives that reached independence by different routes and criticise one another.
- What is proved is that theism is not necessary for grounding; what is not proved is that theism is false or that any one secular grounding is correct.

THE TWO OBJECTIONS THAT MUST BE ANSWERED

- Motivation gap: secular reason may identify duty and fail to motivate. Reply: motivation arises from empathy, identity and respect, and religion is one source rather than a logically necessary one.
- Religious capital: dignity and impartial concern have religious histories. Reply: concede the genealogy, deny that it settles justification, and note that the ancient Indian non-theistic groundings never possessed the alleged capital.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Naming two families and their distinct bills is the cheapest available upgrade on this stem, because writing 'secular ethics' as a single lump concedes the field to the theist.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The strength of secular ethics is not that one theory is unanswerable but that a whole field of them exists, since a dependence thesis is refuted by a field rather than by a champion.

08

STAGE 08 RELIGION'S INFLUENCE ON CONDUCT, AND THE WALL

NARRATIVE EXEMPLARS
RITUAL FORMATION
COMMUNITY AND SANCTION
HOPE AND REPENTANCE
SUSTAINING WORLDVIEW
INFLUENCE IS CONTINGENT
CAUSAL INFLUENCE IS NOT DEPENDENCE
TWO DELIVERABLES IN THE 2023 STEM

exemplars -> ritual -> community -> hope -> worldview -> conduct

conduct -X-> logical dependence conduct -X-> moral truth

THE FIVE MECHANISMS, AND THE CANONICAL CASE

- Exemplars supply models of a life worth imitating; ritual repetition forms habit; community supplies visibility, belonging and correction; hope and repentance make failure survivable; a worldview makes sustained effort intelligible.
- A vow of non-violence may be strengthened by religious discipline while its moral defensibility still requires reasons accessible beyond the community.

THE WALL

- Causal influence does not cross into logical dependence, and it does not cross into moral truth. A correlation between participation and giving is evidence about people, not about obligation.
- Even the causal claim may require controls for community, selection and orientation.

THE SYMMETRY THAT KEEPS THE ACCOUNT EVIDENTIAL

- The same five mechanisms can sanction exclusion: exemplars can be partisan, ritual can substitute for substance, community sanction can police a boundary, hope can be promised selectively and a worldview can divide the world.
- Contingency is not emptiness: traditions remain comparable by how far they build internal critique and moral universalism into the formation they perform.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Belief and practice shape agency without mechanically determining it, so the influence is real, contingent and available in both moral directions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: That religion influences moral behaviour is not in dispute; what is in dispute is what follows, and a causal claim cannot cross into a claim about what makes conduct right.

09

STAGE 09 MORALITY CRITICISING RELIGION: THE SIX TESTS

PROPHETIC CRITIQUE
REFORM AGAINST CASTE AND SATI
ETHICAL-FRUITS TEST
SIX TESTS OF A CLAIMED COMMAND
WITHIN AND ACROSS TRADITIONS
PLURAL MORALITIES
INTERNAL CORRUPTION, NOT COUNTEREXAMPLE

THE SIX TESTS ANY CLAIMED COMMAND MUST PASS

- Identification — is this really a command, and whose? Interpretation — does the text or tradition bear this reading? Consistency — does it cohere with the tradition's own norms?
- Proportionality — is what is demanded proportionate? Human dignity — does it treat persons as ends? Authority — what is the moral standing of whoever invokes it?

WHY INTERNAL CRITIQUE IS THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE

- External criticism can always be met with the charge of imposing alien standards; internal criticism cannot, because the tradition's own vocabulary is doing the work.
- The objection that morality judging revelation is arrogance misdescribes the act: interpretation already uses moral concepts, and what is judged is a human claim about a command rather than the divine as such.

THE INFERENCE THAT FAILS, AND THE DIAGNOSIS THAT HOLDS

- Religious moralities conflict over duties, authority, exceptions and interpretation, so nothing licenses the move from 'religion supports morality' to 'all religions share one moral code'.
- A religion that preserves ritual while sanctioning injustice is internal corruption, as a corrupt court fails BY the standard of law rather than refuting law — but only if morality is genuinely treated as constitutive of worthy religion.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The traffic runs both ways, and the decisive evidence that morality is not simply derived from religion is that religions are reformed by moral argument mounted from inside them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Moral criticism of religion is neither necessarily secular nor necessarily hostile, and it is most powerful precisely where it is internal.

10

STAGE 10 DHARMA, COSMIC ORDER AND KARMA

DHARMA: FOUR STRANDS
NORMATIVE ORDER AND SOCIAL ROLE
RITUAL DUTY AND SOTERIOLOGY
RTA: MORALITY AS THE GRAIN OF REALITY
KARMA: EXHAUSTIVE AND IMPERSONAL
NISKAMA-KARMA, GITA 2.47 AND 3.19
ROLE-DHARMA CAN PRESERVE HIERARCHY
NO INFERENCE OF GUILT FROM SUFFERING

WHY DHARMA IS NOT SIMPLY MORALITY

- It joins normative order, social role, ritual duty and soteriological consequence, so role and ritual obligations fall inside the concept.
- It is not one voice either: Mimamsa grounds ritual duty in injunction, the Gita joins role-duty with disciplined action and devotion, Buddhism grounds conduct in intention and compassion, Jainism radicalises non-injury, and Nyaya and theistic Vedanta connect consequence to divine governance.

THE THIRD OPTION THE INDIAN MATERIAL SUPPLIES

- If morality is the grain of reality rather than a rule imposed on it, immorality is disorder and not merely rule-violation.
- That is a third option beside commanded and self-legislated: morality DISCOVERED as the structure of what there is, needing no divine reason to ground the order.

THE SAFEGUARD AND THE REFORMIST REPLY

- Karma motivates the agent's own accountability and authorises no observer to infer guilt from another's suffering.
- Role-dharma can preserve hierarchy; the reformist reply appeals to non-harm, equality, conscience and spiritual unity, which is internal critique operating inside the Indian material. The standing objection to the whole grounding is unverifiability.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the order is conceived as exhaustive and impersonal it dissolves rather than answers the problem of the undetected act, and it is untouched by the Euthyphro.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Indian material is not decoration on a Western debate: it supplies a family of moral systems in which morality is neither commanded nor self-legislated but is the structure of reality itself.

11

STAGE 11 FOUR NON-THEISTIC GROUNDINGS OF ETHICS

BUDDHIST: INTENTION AND SUFFERING
SANTIDEVA: OWNERLESS SUFFERING
JAIN: AHIMSA AND GRADED VOWS
MIMAMSA: INJUNCTION ALONE
SECULAR WEST: FOUR FAMILIES
RELIGIOUS, NOT SECULAR
STRONG DEPENDENCE REFUTED EMPIRICALLY

WHAT GROUNDS OBLIGATION IN EACH

- Buddhist: intention (cetana), the causal structure of suffering and the four immeasurables — a causal and metaphysical ground rather than a legislative one.
- Jain: non-injury as the supreme vow, graded by the lesser and greater vows, with non-absolutism as an ethic of intellectual non-violence. Mimamsa: injunction alone, which is authority without a commander who is a person.

SANTIDEVA'S ARGUMENT IN THREE STEPS

- There is no substantial self; therefore suffering is ownerless and the boundary between persons is a conventional construction.
- Therefore the reason to relieve another's suffering is exactly as strong as the reason to relieve one's own — impartial altruism on a metaphysical premise, with no theological premise anywhere in the derivation. It depends on no-self being true.

HOW TO RANK THEM, AND WHAT NOT TO CALL THEM

- Mimamsa is the best counterexample to the commander requirement, Santideva the best positive argument for impartial concern, the Jain vow-structure the best model of graded obligation, and the secular families the best evidence of plurality.
- None of the Indian three is a secular ethics. What they defeat is the claim that obligation must be grounded in God or in divine command.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — What theistic ethics distinctively supplies is not the content of morality but a claimed unification of obligation, motivation and cosmic significance in one source.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Four independently developed non-theistic groundings, two of them Indian and ancient, refute the strong dependence thesis empirically as well as conceptually.

12

STAGE 12 BOTH DIRECTIONS TESTED: WITHOUT RELIGION, WITHOUT MORALITY

NECESSITY CLAIM
KANT, MIMAMSA, SANTIDEVA, SECULAR
DESCRIPTIVE VERSUS NORMATIVE
CONSTITUTIVE VERSUS SUPPORTIVE
FUNCTIONAL, NOT STIPULATIVE
NOT A DOSTOEVSKY QUOTATION
STRENGTHENS MOTIVATION, NOT OBLIGATION

DIRECTION ONE — MORALITY WITHOUT RELIGION

- A necessity claim falls to one working counterexample, and here there are four: Kantian self-legislation, Mimamsa's injunction without a personal commander, Santideva's ownerless suffering, and the secular families.
- The 2025 wording straddles grounding and motivation, so split it: as a claim about what makes principles binding it is false, and as a claim about what makes agents feel bound it fails as a necessity claim and survives only as one effective route.

DIRECTION TWO — RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY

- Descriptively yes: an identifiable institution can transmit immoral commands, and calling it immoral does not make it sociologically nonexistent.
- Normatively no: every religion makes claims about worthy life, duty, transformation or liberation, so an ethic is internal to the concept. The constraint is FUNCTIONAL — a system asserting nothing about how to live could not orient a life at all.

THE ASYMMETRY, EXPLAINED RATHER THAN ASSERTED

- Morality is CONSTITUTIVE of what qualifies as a religion; religion is at most SUPPORTIVE of morality; and the two relations differ in kind rather than in degree.
- The concession that must be made and priced: God-reference may strengthen motivation without constituting obligation, and motivation supplied by sanction is heteronomous.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The hardest case is a thin ritual tradition, and the honest answer is that its ethic is thin and contested rather than absent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The asymmetry holds, but for a reason the slogan hides: constitutive and supportive relations are not two degrees of one relation.

13

STAGE 13 WHY BE MORAL ALL THE TIME: THE PROBLEM AND THE TWO FAMILIES

COSTLY, UNDETECTED, UNRECIPROCATED
RING OF GYGES
HOBBES'S FOOLE
HUME'S SENSIBLE KNAVE
BRADLEY AND PRICHARD
JUSTIFICATION VERSUS MOTIVATION
KARMA'S EXHAUSTIVENESS
HETERONOMY IS THE PRICE

THE PROBLEM AT FULL STRENGTH

- Glaucon's Ring of Gyges at Republic II 359d-360b asks whether justice survives invisibility; Hobbes's Foole holds covenant-breaking rational when it pays; Hume's sensible knave makes profitable undetected exceptions and Hume concedes the difficulty.
- Bradley's Essay II and Prichard's 1912 paper press the further point that a demand for a non-moral reason to be moral may be malformed — malformed as a prudential demand, well formed as a motivational one.

FOUR SECULAR ANSWERS AND WHERE EACH STOPS

- Kant: the imperative is categorical, but that explains why the law binds rather than why this agent obeys. Gauthier's constrained maximisation works only where dispositions are detectable.
- Eudaimonism presupposes a thick nature the sceptic can decline; sympathy and reciprocity explain a motive and carry an explicit exception clause for the undetected case.

FIVE RELIGIOUS ANSWERS, AND WHAT EACH COSTS

- Divine sanction abolishes the undetected case at the cost of heteronomy; divine love escapes that cost; karma is exhaustive and impersonal, so Gyges' ring has no purchase.
- Niskama-karma at Gita 2.47 and 3.19 dissolves the question by removing the fruit from deliberation, and dharma or rta makes morality the grain of reality rather than a constraint on it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Secular ethics resolves the justificatory question as well as any theory can, and the printed claim bites only on motivation in the undetected, costly case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The weight of this question is carried by three words, because every theory explains the ordinary case and only the undetected act separates answers from restatements.

14

STAGE 14 RELIGIOSITY AND IMMORALITY: THE AMPLIFIER VERDICT

RELIGIOSITY IS A DISPOSITION
RITUAL SUBSTITUTION
IN-GROUP BOUNDARY-MARKING
TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION
SCRUPULOSITY AND LICENSING
ALLPORT: INTRINSIC AND EXTRINSIC
BATSON: QUEST
AMPLIFIER, NOT ALIGNER

FOUR ROUTES, WITH INTERNAL EVIDENCE

- Ritual substitution is attested by the traditions' own prophetic critiques: Amos 5 and Isaiah 1 on sacrifice without justice, the Buddha on ineffective Vedic sacrifice, Kabir and Nanak on ritualism, and Gita 2.42-43 on those enchanted by flowery words.
- Boundary-marking carries a predictable cost toward outsiders; Kierkegaard's teleological suspension states the override route honestly; scrupulosity and moral licensing fail in opposite directions.

THREE ARGUMENTS AGAINST A SYSTEMATIC CONNECTION

- Every tradition also generates reformers, ascetics and exemplars, so the correlation is with orientation rather than with religiosity.
- The immoral religionist is judged by the tradition's own norms, which is internal corruption; and secular ideologies have produced comparable failures, so religiosity is not the differentiating variable.

THE CONDITIONAL VERDICT AND ITS TWO CONDITIONS

- Religiosity is morally ambivalent rather than morally aligned: it amplifies whatever moral content the religion supplies and whatever motive the individual brings.
- Condition one: is the religion's ultimate itself moralised? Condition two: is the individual's orientation intrinsic or extrinsic? The printed word 'immorality' is retained, and the amplifier is neutral in direction, not in effect.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The directive buys a conditional verdict with the condition named, so neither a flat yes nor a flat no can score on this stem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religiosity does not produce immorality; it magnifies the moral content it is attached to, and the traditions' own prophetic critiques show that they know it.

15

STAGE 15 RELIGIOUS VIOLENCE AND THE RESTRAINT-REGIMES

STRUCTURE OF JUSTIFICATION, NOT HISTORY
VALID BUT UNSOUND
LOCKE 1689: BELIEF IS NOT COMPELLABLE
COMPELLE INTRARE: EXAMINED ONLY
AQUINAS ST II-II q.40; WALZER 1977
QITAL; DHARMA-YUDDHA
KUTA-YUDDHA COUNTER-TRADITION
RESTRAINT, NOT LICENCE

state the argument in premises -> concede validity -> locate the false premise

-> generalise the rebuttals -> name the single survivor

FIVE ARGUMENTS AND FIVE BROKEN PREMISES

- Divine command fails at the identification premise, which Kierkegaard's concession that Abraham cannot make himself intelligible confirms; defence of the sacred conflates value with vulnerability.
- Soteriological paternalism is refuted because its premise is FALSE — Locke shows the understanding cannot be compelled by outward force; cosmic dualism demonises persons, which every major religious anthropology denies; identity-honour is not a religious argument at all.

FOUR GENERAL REBUTTALS AND WHAT SURVIVES

- Euthyphro, epistemic fallibility, Gandhi's means-end unity, and the internal critique present in every tradition.
- Only the ordinary permission of defensive force survives, and it is equally available to a secular ethic — so religion adds no independent licence.

THREE RESTRAINT-REGIMES, AND THE HONEST QUALIFICATION

- Just war (Aquinas: authority, just cause, right intention; Walzer: discrimination and proportionality), the classical juristic treatment of armed struggle under qital, and dharma-yuddha's graded means and lists of the protected converge on five criteria.
- The convergence suggests the constraints are rationally derivable rather than revelation-dependent; each tradition also carries a realist counter-current, and contested items such as the greater-lesser jihad report and the juristic territorial categories must be flagged rather than asserted.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Concede validity, deny soundness and name the premise, because saying that these arguments are illogical misdescribes them and forfeits the analysis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: There is no sound philosophical argument for violence in the name of religion, and what religion distinctively contributes to the ethics of force is restraint rather than licence.

16

STAGE 16 NIETZSCHE ON RELIGION AND MORALITY

GAY SCIENCE 125: CULTURAL DIAGNOSIS
GENEALOGY 1887, THREE ESSAYS
RESSENTIMENT: REACTIVE VALUES
GUILT FROM DEBT; BAD CONSCIENCE
ASCETIC IDEAL; WILL TO TRUTH
SCHELER 1912: LOVE FROM ABUNDANCE
GENETIC FALLACY
NO CRITERION FOR BETTER CREATIONS

THE TWO HALVES, AND THE LINK THE STEM IS BUYING

- The death of God is a cultural diagnosis, not an atheological argument: the Christian-metaphysical framework has become unbelievable to the very culture built on it, and the consequences are delayed.
- The genealogy then asks where the morality that framework carried came from: essay one derives good and evil from the slave revolt and ressentiment, essay two derives guilt from debt and the bad conscience, essay three explains the ascetic ideal's victory and ends with the will to truth destroying the belief in God.

THE POSITIVE PROGRAMME AND ITS UNJUSTIFIED STANDARD

- Revaluation, will to power, the Ubermensch, eternal recurrence and amor fati, with nihilism as the interim rather than the goal.
- It presupposes that valuations can be assessed as life-enhancing or life-denying, which requires a normative standard Nietzsche never systematically justifies.

FOUR OBJECTIONS AND THE INDIAN PARITY

- Genetic fallacy answered by distinguishing value from truth-value; missing criterion; Scheler's Ressentiment arguing that Christian love descends from abundance rather than impotence; and political appropriation.
- Gita 2.3's charge of klaibya is structurally the same accusation but its remedy is svadharma and non-attachment; nirvana is the cessation of craving rather than of life, and Nietzsche rates Buddhism above Christianity as more realistic while still classing it nihilistic.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The stem couples religion with morality, so the connection between the diagnosis and the genealogy is itself part of what is being marked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche makes morality itself an object of suspicion and shows that the death of God is a problem for ethics before it is a problem for theology, which is why his critique is more durable than his solution.

17

STAGE 17 THE BENCH, THE DECODER, THE LADDER AND THE VERDICT

PARITY BENCH: NINE GROUNDINGS
TWO STRESS TESTS
DIRECTIVE DECODER: TEN ROWS
VERDICT LADDER: FIVE BANDS
THREE ARCHITECTURES
FOUR SAFE FORMULATIONS
DISTINGUISHABLE, INTERACTIVE, MUTUALLY CRITICAL
A CONCESSION THAT COSTS SOMETHING

THE BENCH AND ITS TWO STRESS TESTS

- Nine groundings tested against two questions: does it handle the Euthyphro, and does it handle the undetected case? Strong divine command fails the first; contractarianism fails the second; karma and dharma pass both and pay in unverifiability.
- The standing-objection column supplies the evaluative half of the answer automatically: arbitrariness, conceptual independence, nature-to-norm, formalism, detectability, unverifiability, dependence on no-self, rigorism, and external authority.

THE DECODER AND THE LADDER

- Almost every stem here asserts necessity, dependence or incompatibility, so the first move is to ask which of the four relations is being asserted.
- The top band requires a discriminating distinction — semantic against metaphysical dependence, intrinsic against extrinsic religiosity, justification against motivation, restraint against licence — plus a concession that costs the writer's own position something.

THE QUALIFIED CONCLUSION, AND ITS DEFEATER

- Morality has autonomy at the level of grounding, confirmed empirically by four non-theistic groundings; religion nevertheless motivates and sustains it, and morality reciprocally purifies religion. The interaction is itself contingent.
- What would change this verdict is a demonstration that some obligation cannot be grounded without a theistic premise — and the four non-theistic groundings are exactly the evidence that no such demonstration is available.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The synthesis is not written to be deployed but to be selected from, and about a fifth of it belongs in any single answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion and morality are conceptually distinguishable, historically interactive and normatively mutually critical, and every printed stem in this corpus is answerable from those three adjectives.

E

EXTRA OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH — SECOND-ORDER DEBATE ONLY

RELOCATION OF THE DILEMMA
NATURE-TO-NORM, PRESSED FURTHER
EVOLUTIONARY DEBUNKING
ROLE-DHARMA AGAINST UNIVERSALISM
WHAT NOT TO OVER-STUDY

FOUR SECOND-ORDER CONTRASTS

- Whether grounding value in the divine nature answers the Euthyphro or relocates it one step back, as the question of what the goodness of that nature consists in.
- Whether natural law can convert an attractive good into a binding obligation as directly as the categorical imperative does.
- Evolutionary debunking against moral objectivity, which has the same structure as the genetic-fallacy reply to Nietzsche already taught in Core.
- When a tradition contains both a hierarchical role-norm and a universalist critique, what settles which is the tradition's own standard.

SCOPE DISCIPLINE

- Add one advanced move to a fifteen-marker, or one to two to a twenty-marker.
- Do not overload this clause with bioethics, metaethics or contemporary moral psychology; nothing in the audited 2018-2025 bank rewards a survey of applied ethics.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This block is optional enrichment and is unnecessary for a competent core answer, since every printed question the clause owns is fully answered by the core stages above.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels